

‘Outlook’ (PIM and email client software), ‘Publisher’ (desktop publishing software) and ‘Access’ (database manager).

The latest version of Microsoft Office 2013 has a touch friendly and clean interface. You can either buy a one-time licensed copy or go for a subscription-based service (more on this further ahead) called ‘Microsoft Office 365’. Windows XP and Vista users have been left out in this latest version, as it’s only compatible with Windows 7 and 8. It’s available in different packages: Office Home and Student, Office Home and Business, Office Professional and Office 365. The difference between the first three lies in the applications available in the packages. All of them include Word, Excel, PowerPoint and OneNote, but Office Home and Business also contains Outlook, while Office Professional includes Outlook as well as Publisher and Access.

Now coming to the Office 365 version with which Microsoft is achieving new levels of success with the inclusion of subscription plans, updates, advanced settings and document saving. The subscription-based purchase will ensure that your Office 365 suite is always updated even if the software changes. Bundled with this version are most of the applications plus some added cloud benefits such as online storage of files and portability of your personalised settings, among other perks.

The subscription actually works out to be quite cost effective, considering that you’re getting multiple installations and you won’t need to spend again for an upgrade if a new version comes out.

Let’s take a look at the overview of some of the main tools in Microsoft Office 2013:

- ▶ **Word:** Microsoft’s famous word processor has undergone much iteration and exists as a clean interface by following Microsoft’s Design Language. The application is touch optimised and the layout changes if your system has a touchscreen interface, i.e. the buttons become larger with extra space between them.

It has all the regular functions that you might find in a word processor plus some more. Word allows you to directly embed images from Flickr, Bing image search, etc. and videos as well into the document without downloading

	Office Professional 2013 (License)	Office 365 (Home Premium) (Subscription)
Installations	1	5 + (on up to 5 tablets)
Price (In Rs)	30,999	4,199 (per year)

Table source: <http://office.microsoft.com/>